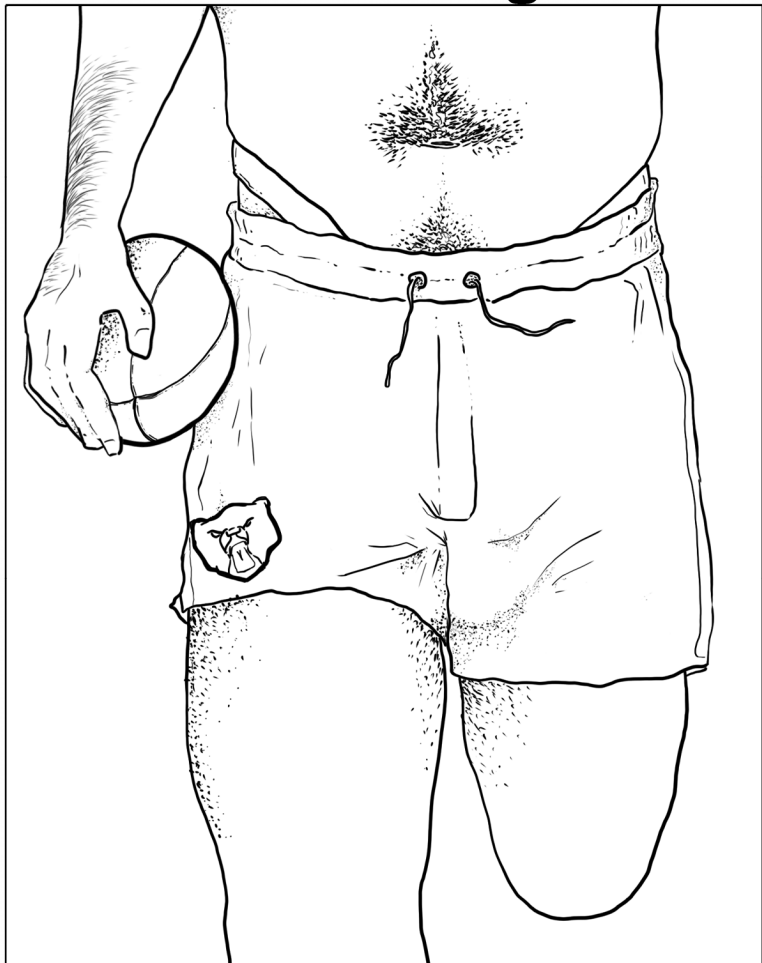


THE PACK^{by} Hugo Cuenot



ADULTS ONLY

Meet the guys :

Finn: Bachelor, still living in his twenties.

Eric: Single and addicted to masturbation.

Rob: Papa bear with a wife and daughter.

Callum: Newlywed with potential regret.

Landon: Unemployed weed addict with on-off girlfriend.

The ball was flying high. Finn caught it and started to run to score. He slammed his big body to the floor while some opponent was grabbing him at the waist, pulling his shorts down a bit. He couldn't care less, the ball was behind the line, the try was scored, pulling his team 3 points above the other two minutes before the end.

The whistle sounding the end of the match had the whole team running on Finn, praising him with accolades and energetics hugs. Even if that was a simple amateur match between two teams of some thirty-year-olds guys playing for fun, winning felt good. The air was electric in the locker room. Imagine some fifteen or so dirty, sweaty, over energized men in a small room, celebrating. It was loud, it smelled like a bear's den. A beautiful collection of dirty shoes, wet

shorts, naked hairy men, and bawdy songs. Soon the picture was blurred by the rising steam from the showers where the party kept going. Grown men are still children. Even with beards and chest full of hair, they were jumping and felt true happiness for a victory before empty bleachers. That didn't matter, for once, they were the winners. Because when they'll leave the stadium, most will go back to their life that they hate, or at least despise.

After a while, everybody's calmed down, chatting as they get dressed up to go to whatever family dinner, picking up some kids, or going on a boring date. Soon the only traces of the euphoria are the mud streaks on the floor and the five guys still dressing and chatting, not wanting to leave. Finn, Eric, Rob, Landon and Callum, a group of friends that have known each other since secondary school, all from the same small village in Essex. All working class and already knee deep in their thirties, they were seeing each other every week for rugby, and usually once a month, they were all going out for a beer together after a match or training. Eric and Rob were already fully dressed, still talking about the match while putting their shoes on.

Landon and Callum were in their underwear, drying their hair, having a conversation about beard grooming, a real man talk. But they were all waiting for Finn, still in the shower. Finn has always been the 'leader' of the group, the charismatic one, the one everyone follows. And that is precisely what the oth-

er guys were doing, waiting for their mate Finn to finish and dress before going anywhere. The dynamic within the group has never really changed, Finn naturally took the place of the leader and the other fell into place behind him, respecting what he has to say, and taking his words very seriously. Some people are like that, maybe it's their aura, maybe it's pheromones, but they will naturally magnetize and federate people around them.

Everyone being ready, they headed out to the moist and grim night. It was like the world decided to set the worst possible weather to let as many people as possible enter a depressive state. Heading in the night, they started to walk towards the city center, a light drizzle making everything wet. They had their habits to an Irish pub that had cheap beer that wasn't piss, and few customers, so they could hang without being disturbed. They didn't go out to socialize or have fun really, they were going out to get their monthly buzz and blow some steam.

Clearly, none of them was happy in their life; Landon was unemployed and a girlfriend with whom he kept breaking up every two months. He was smoking weed for the better part of the day and lying in bed for the rest of it. Rob had a wife and a daughter, even though he clearly would have preferred a son, poor girl. He was a good dad, and a decent husband, but clearly, he was unhappy. Something in his eyes betrayed a deep-rooted sadness. Callum was freshly married and should still be on the new-groom-high,

but he was still scared to be doing a mistake by marrying and was afraid he'd feel stuck. Eric was single and addicted to masturbating. Nobody really knew, but he was swimming in porn, all kinds of it. Some people have stumbled upon it on his phones sometimes but that wasn't enough to reveal his secret. He could do it up to seven times a day and he was cleaning the pipe at least once a day, most of the time, while watching porn. Finn for his part was a real bachelor. Always a girl on his hip. He was a real killer with the ladies and loved to boast about it. He had a new story every week to tell his mates about some girl he shagged the night before, or some ludicrous performance he had done in some improbable location. He was basically living his life the same way he did in his twenties.

That was the whole gang, a bunch of normal guys who all had their vices. They didn't really have to be unhappy, and the weren't entirely unhappy, but each one of them had a little piece of him that was clouded with sorrow.

They were walking slowly, the fatigue of the match showing in their gait. The bags seemed heavier than they were before the match. That might be the drag of the water and mud they were carrying. They were chatting while walking. They might have been tired, but the high from the win kept them on their feet. Rob and Callum were talking about their wives and what it changed for them in their everyday lives:

“See Rob, I thought marriage wasn’t going to be such a big deal, that it wouldn’t really affect me, but now that the papers have been signed for a while, I’ve felt this pressure on chest and my shoulders. When I think about my situation for too long, I get panicky. I think it might be the feeling of being trapped. Is it just in my mind?”

“No, I’ve been through that a little bit too, you’re going to be fine. That’s when you’re going to have a child that you’re going to feel really trapped. You can’t divorce out of a child.”

“That’s true, but it has affected my relationship. The weight of being a good husband didn’t exist before the wedding, and now it’s like a new thing. When I say that I’m married, I feel like people around me expect a certain standard from a married man, and I’m just not sure I can meet them yet. And I’m scared that it will affect my relationship with my wife. It’s almost like now that we’re together for potentially the rest of our lives, I’m going to get bored of her or something.”

Landon intervened in the conversation between the two husbands to let his two cents in like he usually does:

“That’s why I keep breaking up with Betty. I can’t bear the responsibilities of the couple sometimes. Women can be tough too. Don’t beat yourself up, most men go through these questions I think, that’s why, at the end of the day we have each other. And if

you ever feel like you need to take the edge off, give me a call, we'll smoke a little something that'll help you, word."

"I just want a functioning relationship, what's wrong with me?"

The group kept silent, walking in the growing dark. Landon wasn't wrong when he said that at least they had each other; they all felt stronger when they were together, like they were young again. It's like when the band was together, they were suddenly 20 years younger, and it felt great. But when you must go home alone, like they're going to have to tonight, life became absurdly hard, and everything felt out of place for each one of them.

Finn kept quite that night on the way to the pub. The conversation made him think that night. He might not talk about it, or let it show, but he felt the same way. He might be shagging a lot of different girls, all prettier than the other, that never filled the weighty void of his existence pressing on his back.

The chatty Landon broke the silence again, a cloud of smoke trailing behind him.

"But hey, there's hope mate, look at Finn, always with hot ass girls, no strings attached, he's got it figured out, right boss?"

"Yeah, right, ain't no problems for the lady killer."

Finn said with as much enthusiasm as he could put in the lie that his friends would believe anyway. “And that will never be as bad as Erection-Eric, right?”

They all laughed at the joke, even Eric, barely expressing his amused irritation.

“Come on guys, if I wanted a girlfriend, you know I could get one easy! I just like my independence, and you guys are just jealous cause you can’t wank at what you want anymore!”

They eventually reached their rallying point, The Burrow, a small pub right at the entrance of the city, not quite in the city center, and not quite at the periphery. From outside, the low light coming from withing was guiding the group like the moon guides the moths at night. Not even inside, the smell of old brew made them crave a cold beer even more than their unsatisfactory lives. It was small, with low ceiling, rock music playing, three or four tables occupied, and the counter was full of middle-aged men drinking beers and scotch alone.

The pub was almost exclusively frequented by men, not that it wanted to, but the location and the ambience was attracting the same genre of loser. The five of them went to their usual booth, knowing full well that five pints will be greeting them shortly after they sat down. They sat down heavily, and as per usual, a stout man was bringing the five grails for our very tired men. Sat, refreshed, boozed-up, the guys were

finally feeling good again. A warm silence enveloped the group as everyone was sipping their drinks.

After a moment, they started talking about details of the match, training, exercise, muscle mass, and other sports related frivolities. But when you spend so much time with the same people, you tend to exhaust pretty rapidly all the subjects. After yet another exposé by Rob as to why whey is so great for building mass efficiently, Eric cut him short by asking Finn if he had any raunchy anecdotes to tell about any recent affair he's had.

Finn was always happy to tell his stories, seeing the envy in the eyes of his audience.

“Oh yeah, I didn't tell you lads about the last girl, a real freak in the sheets. She had the face of an angel, met her at the club. I don't remember what she was wearing, I only sought to get her undressed. I took her to my place, and right away she threw herself on my cock like a bloody vampire, sucking that thing like her life depended on it, crazy man. The girl was insatiable, I came three times that night, I swear! I shagged the girl in every position possible, filled up all her holes, she couldn't get enough. But the fun part was around the end, I was weak in the knees, bone dry, so she took advantage of me, convincing me to do some butt stuff. What I didn't understand, being too dizzy from breaking my personal record of cummings in the same night was that the butt stuff she wanted was in my butt. I kid you not! I

don't know the face I made when she started to rub a gigantic rubber dick in my bum, but it must have been golden. She even managed to slide in the tip, it felt like shitting in reverse. I think after that the coke she took started to wear off and she fell asleep rather fast, thank God. I was scared I wouldn't be able to come for the match today, 'cause I reckon that just sitting on the bench would have been painful, innit!"

The story made all the guys laugh hard, that was exactly the kind of story the loved to hear from Finn, he always had the most outlandish sex experiences, while making you feel like you were happy that it happened to him and not to you.

"You ought to give me her number Finn, I need to beat that record of yours, I bet I can go all the way up to five times a night!"

"Betty has a thing for butt stuff too, chicks are crazy nowadays right!"

"Damn, I knew the girls you were seeing were freaky, but you're freaky too Finn!"

"Lucky bastard..."

Finn had this power to federate everyone around him, the boys were ecstatic about the story, and not one of them thought it weird that this figure of pure macho masculinity could take a rubber cock up the bum without it making him less of a man. That might

have been the rugby culture, creating an armada of boys comfortable in their bodies, or it could have been the extraordinary charisma of Finn at play.

Rob stood up, still giggling “I gotta take a leak, I laughed too hard man.”

“Yeah, me too, that beer went right through.” Callum followed him to the urinal.

They went to the tiny room, it was dark in it, and like all pub urinals, it had a pungent smell of piss. There were two urinals next to each other, and a single stall that didn’t lock. There were no ladies room, not that they were needed anyway. Rob and Callum started their business next to each other, still laughing at the story. Being inebriated and slightly taller than him, Rob peeked at Callum’s tool, surprised to see that no bush was gracing the shaft, simply a short grass of dark hair.

“Yeah, my wife prefers when I cut it short, less loose hair in the mouth if you see what I mean.”

Rob reached a hand to feel the hair above his friend’s cock, like it was the most natural thing in the world.

“Hum, that’s not super soft, I prefer my big man bush, and my wife never said anything about it, not that I care. What about the balls though, because I like mine smooth as a baby’s head.”

“Oh man, that’s funny, I’m like the complete opposite of you!”

Finishing their business, they both shook their pricks, and without bothering to wash their hands, they went back to the group.

The conversation had shifted from hot-boy night stories to the latest match of their favorite team, bringing the energy of the previous discussion down a notch. Finn had ordered another round of beer that came heavenly for the guys. The lively chatter continued as they kept on drinking. The homey vibe of the pub made them feel right at home and they didn’t want to leave. As the amount of alcohol they ingurgitated increased, their friendliness with each other increased as well. It looked like they couldn’t get their hands off each other, a hand on a thigh, arms around shoulders, heads close to each other.

The night was progressing fast, soon a full moon shining through the clouds was glaring at the group. Even though they were having fun, Finn decided that it was time to go home. Leaving a good dozen of empty pints on the booths’ table, they left the pub far more joyous than they were coming in. They were a happy bunch walking lopsided, entangled together. Landon, red cheeks, and vitreous eyes was feeling ecstatic.

“Come on guys, let’s not cut the good vibes short, and let’s get it going at my place, it’s barely a hundred yards away, and I’m fully stocked on weed and alcohol, that would make me so happy.”

“I’ve got a wife and a kid waiting for me, I can’t be living the bachelor life anymore, you know what I mean, right Callum?” Rob asked, without much entrain in his voice, more trying to convince himself than his friends.

“Yeah, come on guys, let’s all go, at least another round, don’t be a cocksucker!” Finn knew that once he insisted, all resistance would dwindle away, and they’d all go.

Landon wasn’t lying, his flat was in fact really close, they didn’t even have the time to get cold under the moonlit sky that they were already crammed inside, three of them keeping each other warm on the tiny green stained couch while the other two were sitting on the carpet across the coffee table. Weed and wine passing around the table, it quickly went from agitated chatter to calm discussion.

The atmosphere has shifted into something more intimate, low voices, dim lights, and a cloud of smoke to muffle the sounds. Crammed on the couch, Eric was telling some story to Finn, speaking softly in his ear, both absolutely entranced. Landon was resting his head on Callum’s legs, sitting on the ground. The moon winked at them through the window, trigger-

ing something chemical in the air, something that had to do with pheromones or beamed hormones. A change was happening inside the rugby team. Suddenly they became more tactile with each other. Hands on thighs, tangled fingers in curly hair, reddening skin, muscles bulging, pupils dilating. Eric, still talking to Finn, a hand rubbing his thigh softly, the other one around his neck.

Finn was all smiles, sandwiched between Eric and Rob, their large shoulders rubbing against each other. Rob, a joint at the corner of his mouth, noticing what was going on between Finn and Eric wanted in. He boldly put his hand on Finn's chest, catching his attention right away.

The following kiss between Eric and Finn, after the latter had put his hand on his chest would be the kick-starter for an orgiastic night with the boys. Steamy hot strokes, languorous kisses, mind blowing heads, all the way up to an Eiffel Tower.

Fluids flowing freely between them. In a blind folly the five of them let out all their sexual energy into each other. For a night, they let out their inner bestial roughness, only guided by the testosterone surging inside them. For a night, they forgot everything else, they were pure masculine sex.

They'll wake up naked, in the arms of each other, in a flat reeking of sweat and sex, but they'll wake up strangely content, completely unaware of what they did the night before.

And like nothing happened, they'll go back to their lives, to their wives, and back to the club on Monday, for another training. They'll forget the kisses, the caresses, the hair pulling, the fingering, the choking, the spitting, the slapping, the tea bagging, the positions, the switching, the tongues, the hands, the feet, the asses, the nipples, the pricks, the balls, the yelling, the begging, the erections, the edging, the orgasms.

And it won't be until the next full moon that the pack will reunite under the lunar light to complete another cycle.

A group of men in their thirties, a bunch of losers, going from bars to bars, complaining about their lives and their wives. Work, rugby on Friday, bars afterwards. But every month, on a full moon, their instincts take advantage of them, and the pack changes back to what they truly are. That one time every month, they let the uber-ich take the lead. Painful transformation for a night of pure freedom. O to be finally free, to finally be able to let your heart go where it wants to go, to let it run under the full moon. That one time every month, the Pack leaves the closet and just enjoy itself in a wild, bestial orgy.